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Caster et al.

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- (54) **BLUEBERRY PLANT NAMED ‘DRISBLUETHIRTY’**
- (50) Latin Name: *Vaccinium corymbosum* L.
Varietal Denomination: **DrisBlueThirty**
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- (*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 9 days.
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- (52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./157**
- (58) **Field of Classification Search**
USPC Plt./157
See application file for complete search history.
- (56) **References Cited**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named ‘Dris-BlueThirty’, particularly selected as a late and concentrated spring variety with high fruit quality, flavor, and average size, that can be grown under evergreen or mid-chill dormant conditions, is disclosed.

8 Drawing Sheets

Latin name: Botanical classification: *Vacciniitni corymbosum* L.
Varietal denomination: The varietal denomination of the claimed variety of blueberry plant is ‘DrisBlueThirty’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Blueberry plants are perennial flowering plants with indigo-colored berries from the section *Cyanococcus* within the genus *Vaccinium*. Many commercially sold species with English common names, including blueberry, are currently classified in section *Cyanococcus* of the genus *Vaccinium* and come predominantly from North America. Many North American native species of blueberries are grown commercially in the Southern Hemisphere in Australia, New Zealand, and South American nations.
Vaccinium corymbosum, the northern highbush blueberry, is a North American species of blueberry which has become a food crop of significant economic importance. It is native to eastern Canada and the eastern and southern United States, from Ontario east to Nova Scotia and south as far as Florida and eastern Texas. It has been naturalized in Europe,

Japan, New Zealand, and the Pacific Northwest of North America. Other common names include blue huckleberry, tall huckleberry, swamp huckleberry, high blueberry, and swamp blueberry.
Blueberries are usually erect, prostrate shrubs that can vary in size from approximately four inches to approximately 13 feet in height. In the commercial production of blueberries, the smaller species are known as “lowbush blueberries”, while the larger species are known as “highbush blueberries”.
Blueberry bushes typically bear fruit in the middle of the growing season. However, fruiting times can be affected by local conditions such as altitude and latitude. As such, peak crop can vary from May to August in the northern hemisphere, depending upon these conditions.
Blueberries are a popular fruit that is typically consumed as fresh fruit, individually quick frozen (IQF) fruit, or in prepared foods, such as purées, juices, jellies, jams, baked goods, snack foods, and cereals.
Blueberry is an important and valuable fruit crop. Accordingly, there is a need for new varieties of blueberry plant. In

particular, there is a need for improved varieties of blueberry plant that are stable, high yielding, and agronomically sound.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

In order to meet these needs, the present invention is directed to an improved variety of blueberry plant. In particular, the invention relates to a new and distinct variety of blueberry plant (*Vaccinium corymbosum* L.), which has been denominated as 'DrisBlueThirty'.

Blueberry plant variety 'DrisBlueThirty' was selected in Santa Cruz County, California in July 2008 and originated from a controlled cross between the proprietary female parent blueberry plant '127D 2' (unpatented) and the male parent blueberry plant 'DrisBlueFour' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 24,407). The original seedling of the new variety was first asexually propagated via softwood cuttings in Santa Cruz County, California in August 2009.

'DrisBlueThirty' was subsequently asexually propagated via softwood cuttings and underwent further testing in Ventura County, California for seven years (2011 to 2018). The present blueberry variety has been found to be stable and reproduce true to type through successive asexual propagations via softwood cuttings and tissue culture.

'DrisBlueThirty' was selected as a late and concentrated spring variety with high fruit quality, flavor, and average size, that can be grown under evergreen or mid-chill dormant conditions.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

This new blueberry plant variety is illustrated by the accompanying photographs. The colors shown are as true as can be reasonably obtained by conventional photographic procedures. The photographs are of plants that are six and a half years old, unless otherwise specified.

FIG. 1 illustrates whole fruit of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'. From left to right: calyx side up with bloom; pedicel side up with bloom; calyx side up without bloom; and pedicel side up without bloom.

FIG. 2 illustrates transverse (left) and longitudinal (right) cross sections of fruit of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'.

FIG. 3 illustrates a section of a cane of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'.

FIG. 4 illustrates another view of a section of a cane of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'.

FIG. 5 illustrates clusters of flowers of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'.

FIG. 6 illustrates the lower surface (left) and upper surface (right) of leaves of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'.

FIG. 7 illustrates a whole plant of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'.

FIG. 8 illustrates another view of a whole plant of variety 'DrisBlueThirty'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The following description sets forth the distinctive characteristics of 'DrisBlueThirty'. The data which define these characteristics is based on observations taken in Ventura County, California from 2011 to 2018. This description is in accordance with UPOV terminology. Color designations, color descriptions, and other phenotypical descriptions may deviate from the stated values and descriptions depending upon variation in environmental, seasonal, climatic and

cultural conditions. 'DrisBlueThirty' has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions. Unless noted otherwise, the botanical description of 'DrisBlueThirty' was taken from plants that were six and a half years old. The indicated values represent averages calculated from measurements of several plants. Color references are primarily to The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society of London (R.H.S.) (2015 edition). Descriptive terminology follows the *Plant Identification Terminology, An Illustrated Glossary*, 2nd edition by James G. Harris and Melinda Woolf Harris, unless where otherwise defined.

Classification:

Family.—Ericaceae.

Botanical.—*Vaccinium corymbosum* L.

Common name.—Blueberry.

Variety name.—'DrisBlueThirty'.

Parentage:

Female parent.—Proprietary blueberry plant '127D 2' (unpatented).

Male parent.—'DrisBlueFour' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 24,407).

Plant:

Height.—129.3 cm.

Width.—134.3 cm.

Length/width ratio.—~1.0.

Vigor.—Medium.

Growth habit.—Semi-upright.

Chilling requirements.—'DrisBlueThirty' can be grown under evergreen or mid-chill dormant conditions.

Time of vegetative bud burst.—Medium.

One-year-old shoot (young canes).—Length: 47 cm.

Diameter at the base: 9 mm. Diameter at the tip: 3 mm. Internode length on the upper half: 17.8 mm.

Color: RHS N144A. (Strong yellowish green).

Five-year-old shoot (mature canes).—Length: 88 cm.

Diameter at the base: 27 mm. Diameter at the tip: 13 mm.

Leaves:

Length.—67.3 mm.

Width.—42.3 mm.

Length/width ratio.—1.6.

Internode length.—25.23 mm.

Shape.—Ovate.

Margin.—Entire.

Arrangement.—Alternate.

Color on upper side.—RHS 147A (Moderate olive green).

Color on lower side.—RHS 191B (Greyish yellow green).

Vein color.—RHS 148D (Greyish yellow green).

Venation pattern.—Reticulate.

Glaucosity on upper side.—Weak.

Petiole.—Length: 4.0 mm. Diameter: 2.19 mm. Color: RHS 193A (Pale yellow green).

Flowers:

Flower length (excluding pedicel).—16.64 mm.

Flower width.—7.31 mm.

Flower length/width ratio.—2.3.

Flower bud.—Length: 5 mm. Width: 4 mm. Number of flowers per bud: 3. Anthocyanin color: Weak. Overall color: RHS 157A (Pale yellow green).

Flower pedicel.—Length: 6.19 mm. Diameter: 1.26 mm. Color: RHS 142C (Light yellow green).

Corolla.—Shape: Urceolate. Color of corolla tube: RHS 157A (Whitish green). Anthocyanin coloration of corolla tube on outer side: Absent. Conspicuousness of ridges on corolla tube: Absent. Color of receptacle: RHS 143C (Green). Diameter of corolla aperture: 3.99 mm. Petal width (ridge to ridge): 5.36 mm.

Reproductive organs.—Style length (including stigma): 7.37 mm.

Flowering interval on one-year-old shoot.—February to April.

Flowering interval on current year's shoot.—February to April.

Fruit:

Length.—12.52 mm.

Width.—15.80 mm.

Length/width ratio.—0.8.

Weight.—2.2 grams/fruit.

Shape in longitudinal section.—Oblate.

Attitude of sepals.—Semi-erect.

Type of sepals.—Straight.

Calyx basin.—Diameter: 6.37 mm. Depth: 1.22 mm. Diameter/depth ratio: 5.2.

Infructescence (fruit cluster).—Number of berries per cluster: 3.60. Density: Medium. Peduncle length: 12.64 mm.

Fruit pedicel.—Diameter: 2.36 mm.

Color of unripe fruit.—RHS 143C (Strong yellow green).

Intensity of bloom.—Medium.

Color of skin after removal of bloom on mature fruit.—RHS N186A (Dark purplish grey).

Color of flesh.—RHS 145C (Light yellow green).

Fruit firmness.—Firm.

Sweetness.—Medium.

Acidity.—Low.

Seeds.—Color: RHS 166C (Brownish orange).

Fruiting.—Fruiting type: On one-year-old and current season's shoots. Harvest interval on one-year-old shoot: April to June. Harvest interval on current year's shoot: April to June. Yield: 11,000 kg to

16,000 kg of fruit per hectare per season from 36 to 60-month old plants when grown at Ventura County, California.

Resistance to abiotic stress, pests, and diseases:

Heat.—Moderately resistant.

Blueberry bud mite (Acalitus vaccini).—Moderately resistant.

Botrytis fruit rot (Botrytis cinerea).—Moderately resistant.

COMPARISONS TO PARENTAL AND REFERENCE BLUEBERRY VARIETIES

'DrisBlueThirty' differs from the female parent proprietary blueberry plant '127D 2' (unpatented) in that 'DrisBlueThirty' has a larger fruit size and firmer fruit texture than '127D 2'. 'DrisBlueThirty' also has the ability to produce fruit on both current season and one-year-old shoots.

'DrisBlueThirty' differs from the male parent and reference variety 'DrisBlueFour' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 24,407) in that 'DrisBlueThirty' has short length of internodes on one-year-old shoots (upper half), broad leaf width, medium intensity of bloom on fruit, and bears fruit on both one-year-old and current season's shoots, whereas 'DrisBlueFour' has medium length of internodes on one-year-old shoots (upper half), medium leaf width, very strong intensity of bloom on fruit, and bears fruit on one-year-old shoots only.

'DrisBlueThirty' differs from the reference blueberry plant variety 'DrisBlueSeven' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 24,605) in that 'DrisBlueThirty' has medium time of vegetative bud burst, anthocyanin coloration of corolla tube is absent, medium intensity of bloom on fruit, and bears fruit on both one-year-old and current season's shoots, whereas 'DrisBlueSeven' has very early time of vegetative bud burst, weak anthocyanin coloration of corolla tube, very strong intensity of bloom on fruit, and bears fruit on one-year-old shoots only.

What is claimed is:

1. A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant designated 'DrisBlueThirty' as shown and described herein.

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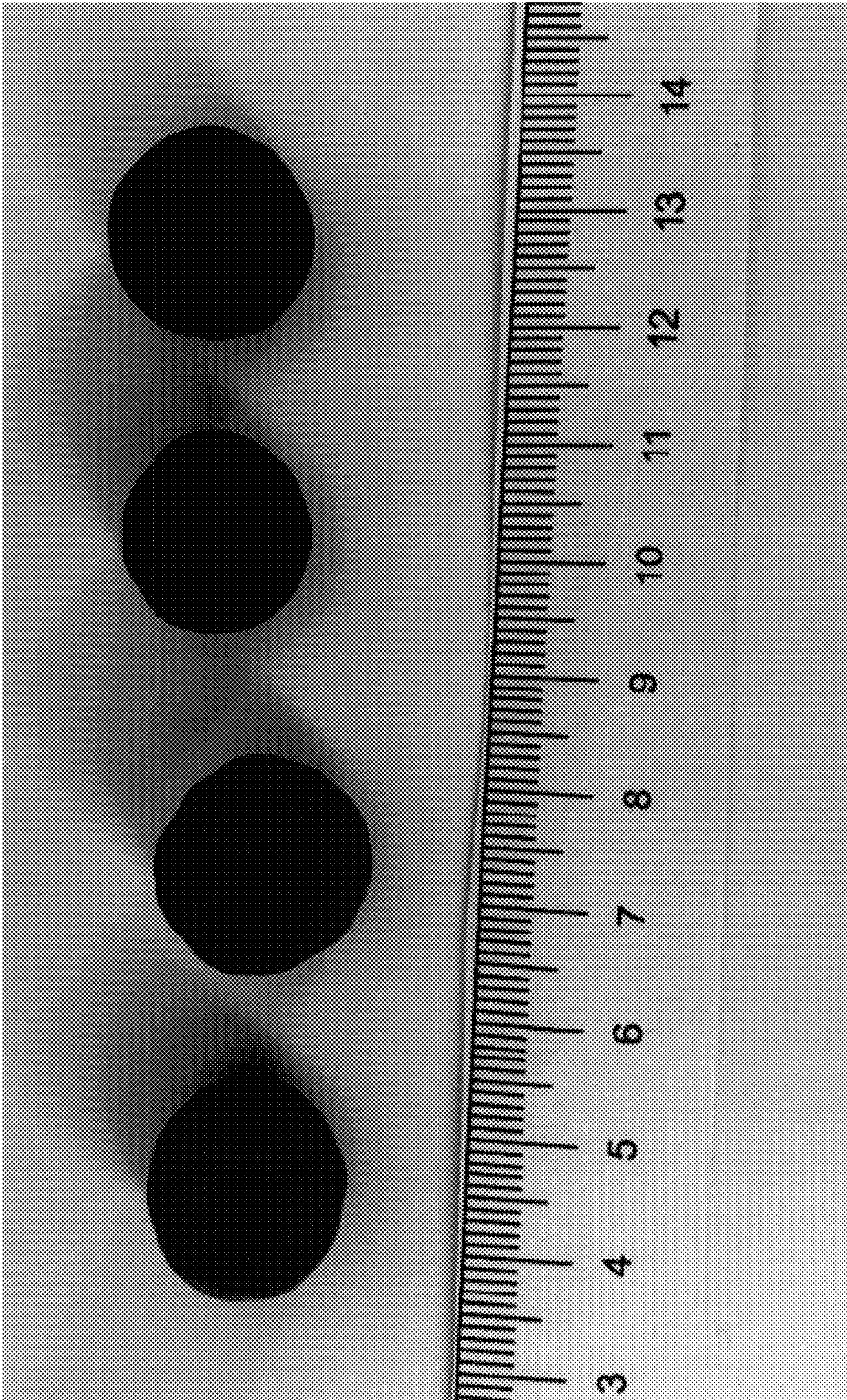


FIG. 1

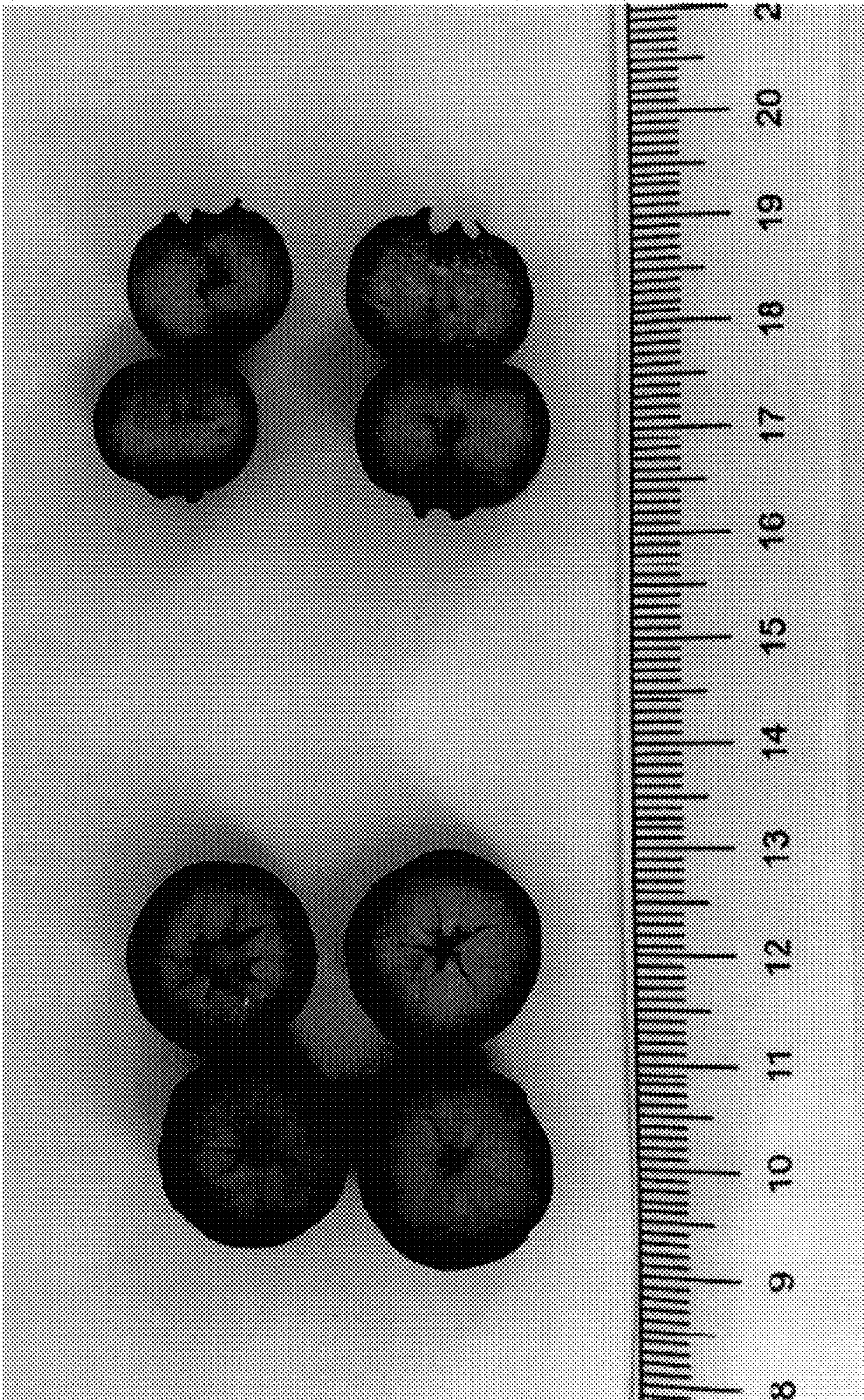


FIG. 2

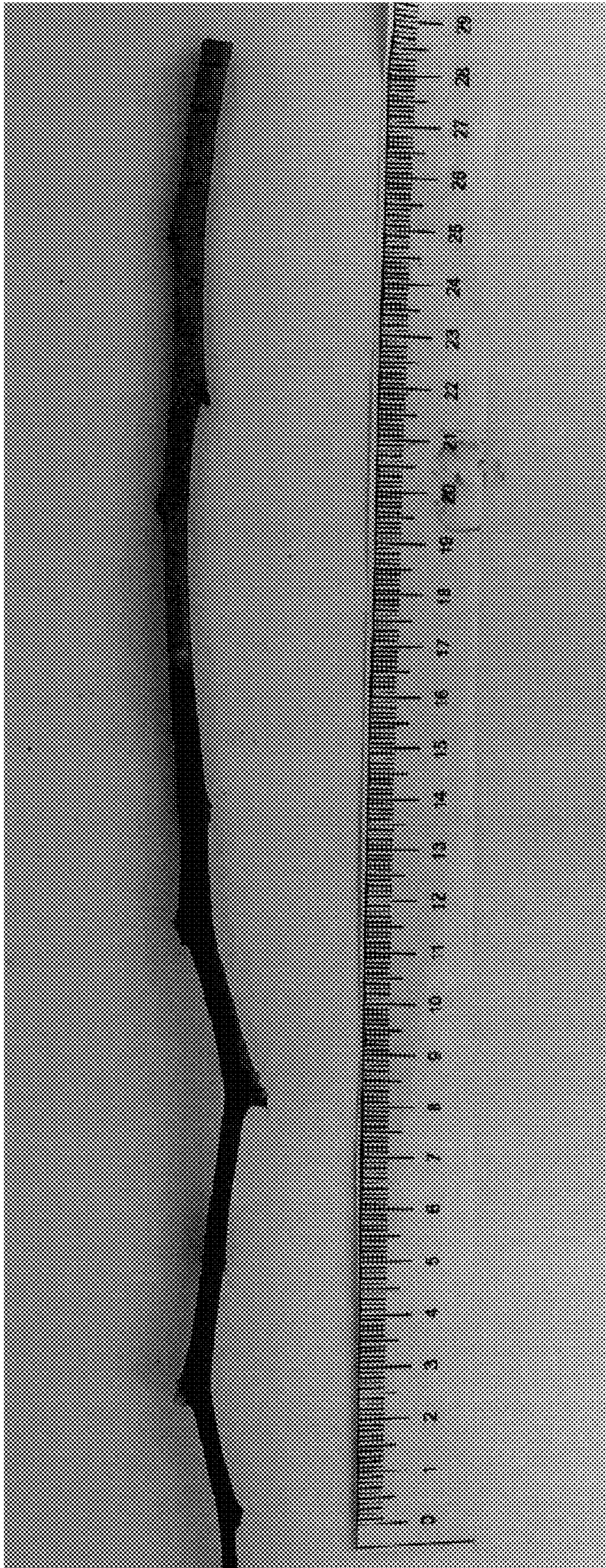


FIG. 3

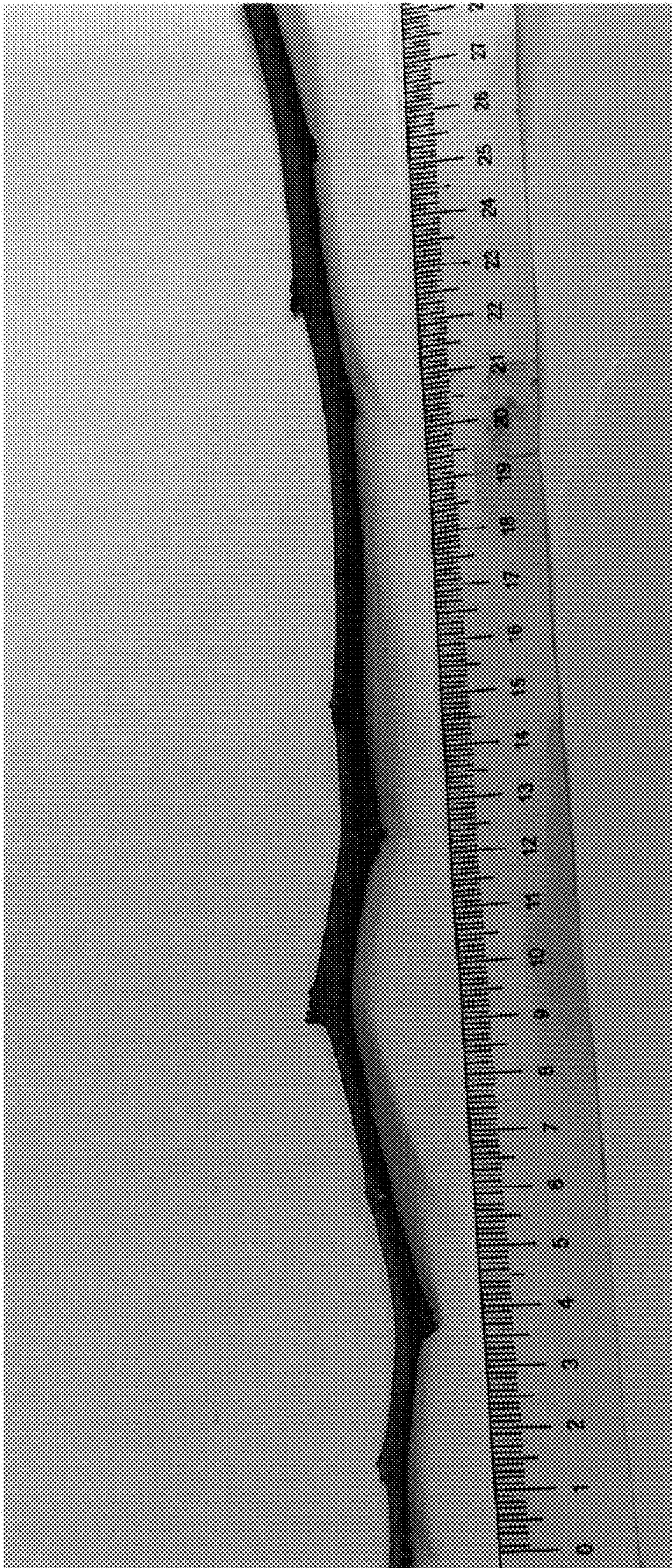


FIG. 4

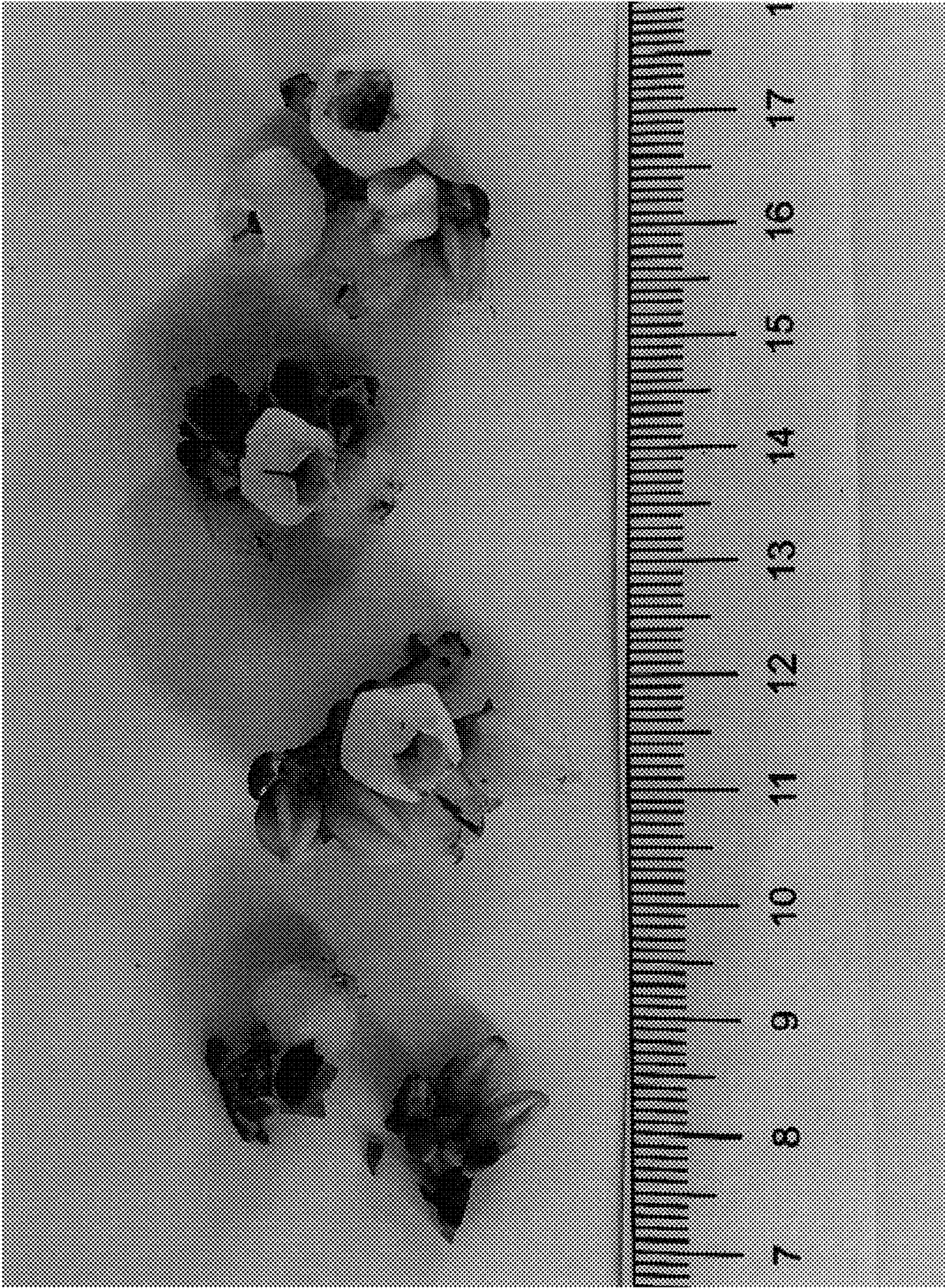


FIG. 5



FIG. 6



FIG. 7



FIG. 8